

Chapter 23-1

Actually, even without her saying it, Liang Shi could guess.

Russian roulette was a drinking game played at drinking tables. There were six glasses of alcohol in total, and players would take turns rolling dice, drinking whichever numbered glass corresponded to the number they rolled.

This continued until the dice you rolled corresponded to an empty glass, at which point your turn would end.

However, you would then be responsible for refilling that glass.

If you were lucky, you basically wouldn't have to drink much.

But if your luck was terrible, one person might end up drinking all six glasses.

Liang Shi had previously seen this type of game at a dinner party after an audition in a film crew, where more than twenty bottles of beer were consumed in less than half an hour.

Several female acting students were forced to drink a lot, and the director and producers' hands began wandering inappropriately toward those girls.

Liang Shi couldn't stand watching it anymore and left the gathering.

She also called the girls' teacher along the way.

Later, she didn't know whether those people succeeded in their intentions, because although she had passed the audition and gotten the role, due to the toxic atmosphere of that crew, she chose to give it up.

Even though it was a decent script.

And at this moment, judging from the photos, those wine glasses were not small.

Moreover, there were many bottles scattered messily on the table—not only beer, but also some inferior wine and more beer.

Beer bottles were the most numerous.

In the private room, there were men and women, and some people appeared to be in an extremely excited state.

Liang Shi glanced at the message, confirmed the location, and immediately headed out.

Just then, Xu Qingya came out of her room. Seeing her hurried figure, she couldn't help but ask: "Sister Liang, where are you going?"

Liang Shi didn't look back as she grabbed a pair of comfortable sneakers from the shoe cabinet: "To find your sister."

Xu Qingya was stunned: "She hasn't come back yet?"

"She's at Huayue International¹," Liang Shi said. "Trapped there with Bai Weiwei."

"Damn." Xu Qingya cursed, immediately stuffing her phone in her pocket. "I'm coming with you."

"You know about Huayue International?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingya casually tied up her hair: "Who in Haichuan doesn't know? It's a famous money pit²—people who go there are the type who love to play recklessly. Sometimes when they're drunk and wild, they don't care about anything. There were even fatalities there a few years ago."

"How is a place like that still not shut down?" Liang Shi grumbled irritably, completely unaware that her state of mind had been thrown into complete chaos by that photo.

"It can't be shut down," Xu Qingya said. "They only provide the venue, they don't provide the substances. A lot of the stuff comes from those scumbags buying from the black market themselves. And do you know who's backing Huayue International?"

"Who?" Liang Shi asked.

She also didn't realize that she was actually relying on a fifteen-year-old girl to explain these things to her.

However, this showed that Xu Qingya really knew quite a lot.

Probably more than Xu Qingzhu knew.

It was likely because Xu Qingya often hung around with some good-for-nothing rich second-generation kids, so she understood these places.

"The Shen family," Xu Qingya shrugged. "Who would dare to easily touch Huayue International? Touching it would be openly opposing the Shen family."

Liang Shi didn't know what background this Shen family had, but obviously, now wasn't a good time to inquire.

She promptly reined in her curiosity: "Let's go find your sister first."

Footnotes:

¹ Huayue International: A high-end entertainment establishment/club

² Money pit: A place where wealthy people go to spend money extravagantly

Chapter 23-2

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Xu Qingya sat in the car and called Xu Qingzhu several times, but the phone was always turned off.

Thinking of Bai Weiwei, Liang Shi flipped through her contacts to find Zhao Xuning's contact information. Fortunately, she had been clever at the time and found Zhao Xuning's phone number from the hospital's information system, thinking that if she encountered an emergency situation in the future, she could contact her.

And now she really had encountered one.

She called Zhao Xuning, who seemed to be sleeping and sounded somewhat impatient: "Who is it?"

Liang Shi said gently: "It's Liang Shi."

Zhao Xuning paused, reining in some of that impatience, though her tone still wasn't particularly good: "What do you want so late at night?"

"I'm sorry," Liang Shi apologized first.

Zhao Xuning was straightforward: "If you have something to say, say it. If not, I'm hanging up."

"I do," Liang Shi said. "Bai Weiwei is at Huayue International right now."

"Just her alone?" Zhao Xuning said. "She goes there often."

"Playing games with people," Liang Shi explained. "I don't know why, but she also called Xu Qingzhu to go. Someone just sent me photos—they're both drunk."

"Damn." Zhao Xuning cursed under her breath. "These inhuman bastards."

"Huh?" Liang Shi had just turned a corner, and Zhao Xuning spoke too quietly for her to hear clearly, so she asked: "What did you say?"

Zhao Xuning said irritably: "Nothing."

There were rustling sounds from the other end of the phone, probably from changing clothes.

"Which specific private room number," Zhao Xuning said. "I'm close to Huayue International, I'll go over first."

"..."

Liang Shi was confused and said rather embarrassedly: "I didn't ask."

Zhao Xuning: "...?"

On this end of the phone, Liang Shi could imagine how Zhao Xuning wanted to curse her—What the fuck, you don't even know the room number and you're calling me?

Liang Shi coughed lightly: "I'll call and ask now."

She hung up and called that number from before.

But that number was no longer answering.

At the same time, Zhao Xuning sent a text: 【Show me the photos.】

Liang Shi had Xu Qingya forward the photos to her.

After Xu Qingya sent them, she zoomed in on the photos to look, and almost simultaneously with Zhao Xuning, recognized: "This is 7588."

Zhao Xuning's text also came: she also guessed it was 7588.

Liang Shi was surprised—they could recognize it from this?

"How did you recognize it?" Liang Shi asked.

Xu Qingya turned off her phone screen and put her phone back in the storage compartment: "Every private room at Huayue International has some distinctive items or architecture. Rooms one through twelve are based on the zodiac animals, and each room is decorated according to the zodiac theme, with elements related to the zodiac animals. The later numbered rooms are random. 7588's symbol is deer—there are deer on the table in the photo, the light and shadows projected on the wall are also deer, and there's a deer ornament in the bottom right corner."

"I see." Liang Shi hadn't expected that even a private room would have so many details.

Even though she wasn't inexperienced with the world, she was still a bit surprised.

Someone who could come up with this kind of decoration style was definitely no ordinary person.

"But this private room..." Xu Qingya frowned and paused.

Liang Shi noticed something off in her tone: "What's wrong?"

"Drive faster," Xu Qingya grabbed the handle on the side of the car. "My sister is in danger."

Liang Shi: "...What do you mean?"

Xu Qingya's eyes were already red. She closed her eyes and said in a choked voice: "After ten o'clock, the inhibitors¹ will lose their effect on everyone in this private room."

Liang Shi: "?"

"They'll enter heat, and it's different from normal heat periods," Xu Qingya said. "I heard people say that the last drink they have before ten o'clock will have something in it..."

This kind of drug was something she felt embarrassed to mention.

So she deliberately avoided it: "After ten o'clock, this private room will gradually become a paradise² for Alphas and Omegas to revel, and people generally call it the Tender Village³."

"This private room doesn't open easily, and normally it only operates until ten o'clock," Xu Qingya said.

"Then it should be fine, right?" Liang Shi said. "Why would they even advertise this gimmick?"

"But it doesn't close on Saturday nights," Xu Qingya let out a light breath, almost crying from anger. "Who the hell is this? Are they crazy? Bringing Xu Qingzhu to that kind of place? Damn it, if I find out who it was, I'll kill them!"

Xu Qingya's tone was agitated, and by the end of her words, her voice was already trembling.

A teenage girl had never experienced such a major incident before, and just thinking about it was terrifying.

She clenched her fists and pleaded: "Sister Liang, please hurry, okay? If Xu Qingzhu experiences something like this, she'll definitely go insane."

In her urgency, she couldn't even be bothered to call her "sister" anymore.

"When she's drunk, her senses become more sensitive. If she's forced..." Xu Qingya already felt like she was suffocating, her heart felt like someone had grabbed it and punched it hard. She couldn't help but cry out: "She has PTSD⁴!"

Liang Shi was infected by this sorrowful emotion.

She pressed the gas pedal to the floor. There wasn't much traffic on the road, and on the empty road, the white Porsche sped past like lightning. Passersby could only catch a glimpse of the car's tail in the blink of an eye.

"Don't worry," Liang Shi tried to maintain her composure to comfort Xu Qingya. "We'll make it in time. Your sister will be fine."

"I hope so," Xu Qingya said through gritted teeth. "If I find out who brought her there, I'll hack them to pieces."

Liang Shi: "..."

Who would have thought—she's actually a sister-protecting maniac.

Liang Shi suddenly felt a chill on the back of her neck.

If Xu Qingya found out about the things the original owner had done, she'd probably be the first to grab a knife and enter the villa.

And give her a stab when she wasn't paying attention.

Liang Shi shrank her neck, but her foot movements didn't slack off at all.

Just thinking that Xu Qingzhu might have a PTSD episode made her heart ache.

The scene of Xu Qingzhu's PTSD episode that day was still vivid in her mind—her screams were like those of a helpless, lost child.

Liang Shi really couldn't bear it.

It was hard to find parking near Huayue International.

But Liang Shi couldn't care about that much anymore. She parked the car directly at the entrance and hurriedly got out, just as Zhao Xuning, who had rushed over, arrived.

Xu Qingya had already run toward the entrance.

But she was stopped by security at the door.

Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning didn't exchange pleasantries either, skipping all the necessary steps of meeting and directly exchanged a glance to understand each other's meaning.

Footnotes:

¹ Inhibitors: In ABO dynamics, medications used to suppress or control pheromones and heat/rut cycles

² Paradise: A place of indulgence and pleasure

³ Tender Village: A euphemistic term for a place of sensual pleasure or debauchery

⁴ PTSD: Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder, a mental health condition triggered by experiencing or witnessing a traumatic event

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Xu Qingya was already arguing with security at the entrance: "I need to go in and find someone. There's not much time left. Damn it, if someone dies, can you afford to compensate? If you don't let me in, I'm calling the police. I'm going to report you for prostitution¹!"

"Miss, how can you speak like that? We operate a legitimate business here and never do anything illegal. How can you just speak so recklessly?" A man in a black suit walked over. "If you want to come in to find someone, please call the person you're looking for, or tell us the room number and we'll help you find them. But if you're here to cause trouble, don't blame us for taking action."

"You're the prostitute²! Your whole family are prostitutes!" Xu Qingya roared. "Try laying a hand on me! I'll report you every damn day!"

Liang Shi: "..."

So this girl was actually a hothead?

Xu Qingya was already being held by two security guards and couldn't move, but she was still struggling. Liang Shi immediately walked over: "Let go of my sister."

When the security guards saw it was her, they immediately let go and bowed their heads respectfully: "Miss Liang."

Liang Shi: "?"

The original owner could actually get VIP treatment here?

Looked like she was a regular.

The man in the black suit also walked over, bowing respectfully: "Miss Liang, you haven't been here for a long time. What wind brought you here today?"

"I'm here to find my wife," Liang Shi said. "In private room 7588."

"7588?" The man's eyebrows furrowed slightly, but then quickly relaxed as he smiled: "Room 7588 is very lively tonight, and besides, it's already 10:01. According to the rules, the door to 7588 won't open after ten o'clock."

So the inhibitors would lose their effect, and the pheromones of Omegas and Alphas would mix together. According to the law of mutual attraction between pheromones, they would trigger people's deepest instincts.

Complete strangers—Alphas and Omegas—would spend an unforgettable night together in chaos here.

Weren't they afraid of anti-pornography campaigns³?

The man said: "The guests of 7588 have already entered their respective rooms. We won't disturb our customers' rest."

"What if I insist on opening it?" Liang Shi raised an eyebrow, her aura immediately commanding.

Her long hair was blown by the wind, her brown pupils stared intently at the man, her brow slightly furrowed. Multiple emotions flashed across her stunning face, but finally settled into something sharp and cold.

Those eyes seemed to contain ice blades, piercing into the man: "Are you going to stop me?"

Liang Shi was gambling—betting on the Liang family's status in Haichuan City.

Also betting on the original owner's spending power here.

The man was indeed stunned, then smiled: "I certainly wouldn't dare stop Miss Liang."

"It's just that..."

"There's no 'just that.'" Zhao Xuning looked at her watch behind Liang Shi and spoke impatiently: "It's already 10:03. You have two minutes to take us upstairs. If we miss this window, tomorrow's media will publish a story, and all those things Huayue International suppressed before, I can make them explode overnight. I know you're backed by the Shen family, but no matter how you calculate it, this place is just a branch of the Shen family. I don't believe the Shen family would go to great lengths to oppose both the Liang and Zhao families for a mere branch."

Zhao Xuning's voice was clear and cold, carrying with it the bitter wind, not yielding an inch.

The man's expression changed slightly, the smile on his face stiffened, and for a moment he didn't know what to do.

These words—his level was too low to handle such matters; he could only listen.

"Let's go," Zhao Xuning called to Liang Shi. "Upstairs."

Liang Shi casually swept her gaze across the man's face, and that one glance made him shiver.

He had met Miss Liang before, and his impression of her was still that of someone dissolute and unrestrained. When she came with Miss Cheng, she was always lazy, only showing interest when encountering exceptional Omegas, though most of her energy was spent on playing.

She had come with Miss Cheng several times even after getting married.

He heard she had married Haichuan's number one Omega, but every time she came, he heard Miss Liang complaining impatiently, saying the one at home was just a vase you could look at but not play with.

Moreover, Miss Liang had many tricks. Every time those Omegas spent a night with her, they needed several days to recover from their injuries.

But today's Miss Liang carried herself with the aura of someone in power. Especially that sideways glance—it made his spine go cold. If he didn't have some self-control, he might have bent his knees and fallen to the ground.

The man swallowed and patted his chest after they left.

A security guard asked: "Boss, are we just letting them go in like that? What if Miss Cheng blames us..."

"Miss Cheng didn't say not to let them in," the man said. "Besides, wasn't this whole setup prepared by Miss Cheng for Miss Liang?"

Otherwise, why would she go through all the trouble to trick Miss Liang's wife into coming here and then let Miss Liang know which private room?

Miss Cheng's real target was Miss Liang.

"Aren't they good friends? How could she scheme against her friend's wife too?" The security guard scratched his head in confusion.

The man shook his head: "Who knows?"

There were too many twists and turns among these wealthy families. Today's friends could be tomorrow's enemies.

There were never eternal friends.

Generally, people with common interests could be friends, but once their positions conflicted, they could quickly split apart.

The security guard wanted to say more, but the man glared at him: "Why are you asking so many questions? Mind your own business."

Footnotes:

¹ Prostitution: Xu Qingya is threatening to report the establishment for illegal activities

² The term "小姐" (xiaojie) in this context can mean both "miss" (polite form of address) and "prostitute" (slang), so Xu Qingya is turning the insult back on them

³ Anti-pornography campaigns: Government crackdowns on illegal adult entertainment businesses in China

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Meanwhile, on the other side.

Liang Shi, Zhao Xuning, and Xu Qingya took the elevator directly to the twelfth floor.

Zhao Xuning had been to this place before, but she disdained associating with them. Even if she entered room 7588, she would at most drink some sake and had never been to 7588 on a Saturday.

She had no idea what 7588 looked like on Saturday nights after ten o'clock.

She had only heard people mention it in passing during casual conversations.

She heard that everyone would be automatically paired up, and at ten o'clock, 7588's hidden compartments would automatically open and then extend into individual rooms.

Each room was decorated with great style.

Zhao Xuning was used to keeping herself pure and had never been interested in such vulgar matters.

The floor was paved with gold-plated flooring, and the chandeliers in the corridor were also luxurious, even a grade higher than the chandeliers in Liang Shi's villa.

It truly deserved to be called a place of extravagant debauchery¹.

But they had no heart to appreciate this extravagant debauchery.

As soon as they got off the elevator, they headed straight for private room 7588, but just as that person had said, the door to room 7588 was locked after ten o'clock.

No server dared to open it.

Even the entire corridor was empty, without a trace of human presence.

Liang Shi asked Zhao Xuning: "Is there any other way?"

Zhao Xuning was also getting frustrated and instinctively snapped: "You've been to this place more than I have. If you don't have a solution, what solution could I have?"

Liang Shi: "..."

After saying this, Zhao Xuning realized what she'd done and apologized promptly: "Sorry, I..."

"It's fine, I understand." Liang Shi's emotions were the most composed among them. Xu Qingya was already constantly trying various ways to open the door, but the door was made of iron and used a special lock—it was impossible to pull open with human strength.

While trying to open the door, Xu Qingya was also shouting: "Xu Qingzhu! Xu Qingzhu! Can you hear me? If you can hear me, answer!"

Her hoarse voice echoed through the corridor.

Liang Shi observed their surroundings. They must have been given instructions to withdraw all the waitstaff from this floor.

After thinking for a moment, she took out her phone and dialed 110.

The call was quickly answered, and she said calmly: "Hello, I want to make an anonymous report. Huayue International is suspected of engaging in obscene business."

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Zhao Xuning took out her phone and called her sister: "Sister, I need a favor."

The person on the other end frowned: "You know that Huayue International is backed by the Shen family. No matter how rich our family is, can we compare to the Shen family?"

"Don't you know anyone from the Shen family?" After saying this, Zhao Xuning paused.

Her sister said helplessly: "Don't you know someone?"

Zhao Xuning: "...It's been many years since we last contacted each other."

After reporting to the police, Liang Shi also actively contacted Liang Xinhe. With a two-pronged approach, at least one of them should work.

But Liang Xinhe's phone kept showing as busy.

She didn't know who he was chatting with.

She sent a text: 【Emergency! Call back ASAP!】

She didn't know if Liang Xinhe could see it.

But before Liang Xinhe called back, she received another photo.

In the photo, Xu Qingzhu was lying on a white bed, with her black tight sweater thrown to one side of the bed, and the sheets were wrinkled.

Xu Qingzhu's thick, long hair was spread like seaweed across the white sheets. Her cheeks had an abnormal flush, and her beautiful eyes were half-closed, with heavy, fine shadows falling on her lower eyelids. Her lips were bright red and glistening, like freshly polished jade with a layer of frost.

She lay in an extremely seductive pose, her socks had been removed, revealing her slender, pale ankles, and her white toes also had an improper redness.

She wore a white camisole on top and black tight pants on the bottom, which tightly wrapped around her long, slender legs.

Her small waist was faintly visible.

At this moment, in this photo, Xu Qingzhu perfectly combined the two qualities of beauty and coldness.

No one in this world could resist such a Xu Qingzhu.

Just looking at her could make someone's nose bleed.

Liang Shi gritted her teeth and cursed: "Beast."

She immediately called back, but no one answered on the other end.

Soon another text message came: 【I told you, if you come any later, what's on the roulette might not be alcohol but your wife.】

Liang Shi pressed the screen and typed rapidly: 【Who are you exactly? Let my wife go.】

She also started calling her "wife."

The other party sent another text: 【The drugs in 7588 are no joke. Don't believe me? Look at what her hands are doing.】

Then came another photo.

Xu Qingzhu's hand was reaching toward her heart.

That place held unknown softness.

And the expression on her face became even more dreamy.

Damn.

The other party: 【How is it? Does it hurt not being able to appreciate such beautiful scenery?】

Liang Shi frantically called back, but still no one answered.

Liang Shi felt like the other party was a hunter, step by step leading her toward a prepared trap.

But she had no choice but to walk toward it, because the stakes were Xu Qingzhu.

Footnotes:

¹ Extravagant debauchery: The Chinese phrase "纸醉金迷" literally means "drunk on paper, lost in gold," referring to a lifestyle of luxury and indulgence

Chapter 23-5

This was the first time Liang Shi had felt anger so intense she couldn't suppress it.

Another text message came.

【If you still can't get in, she's going to become someone else's.】

Liang Shi quickly replied: 【Whatever you want is fine, just don't touch her.】

The other party: 【Really? But I don't want anything.】

Liang Shi: ...

What a fucking asshole.

Liang Shi really wanted to hit something right now.

She had just thought Xu Qingya was a bit hot-tempered, but now she felt like she was becoming a second Xu Qingya.

If she found out who the other party was, she'd have to hack that bastard to pieces too.

Another photo was sent.

The photo no longer showed just Xu Qingzhu alone. A short, stocky woman had climbed onto Xu Qingzhu's bed, creating a stark visual contrast.

The woman was pressing down on Xu Qingzhu's arm, and Xu Qingzhu's expression had changed too—no longer as dreamy as before.

Probably the approach of a stranger had made her alert, so she started struggling.

Another text message was sent.

【I heard she seems to have PTSD¹. I haven't seen it before.】

【What's a PTSD episode like? Is it scary? Would she kill someone?】

【Our little lady has never tasted such a delicious Omega in her lifetime. Tonight will definitely be a feast.】

Even though it was sent as text through a screen, it still carried a disgusting tone.

To her, Xu Qingzhu seemed not to be a person, but a dish—a dish that could be enjoyed at will.

And the tone was so infuriating.

Liang Shi went along with her words: 【Try triggering Xu Qingzhu's PTSD and see what happens!】

【PTSD episodes don't kill people, but I fucking will.】

She was truly furious.

Liang Shi, who was usually well-mannered and rarely used profanity, was so angry that she couldn't speak without swearing.

When people get angry to the point of speechlessness, they feel like they can't express themselves without swear words.

Only these national treasures² could express her feelings.

The other party: 【Oh? I'm looking forward to it.】

【But you'd better hurry, or your wife is going to be slept with by someone else.】

【Do you have a mirror nearby? Look at the top of your head—is it green³?】

【Tsk tsk, you must be furious right now, wanting to know who I am, right?】

Liang Shi: "..."

Fucking idiot.

She knew the other party was just trying to provoke her. It was such a crude tactic that it was easy to see through.

But what she said was too excessive and could easily stir up people's emotions.

Liang Shi decided to block her messages, but before blocking them, she saw the other party had sent another one, and her hand paused.

【Five more minutes, and Xu Qingzhu's drug effects will reach their most intense moment.】

Liang Shi: "..."

Bullshit.

Soon, another message came.

【If your timing is coincidental when you come in, you might even see your wife being pleasured under someone else.】

Two seconds later, another one.

【Finally, it's your turn.】

Liang Shi: ?

Liang Shi didn't know how many people the original owner had offended. With her previous personality, if she had been in an ordinary family, she would have been beaten eight hundred times already.

And now, this incident was clearly targeting the original owner.

They were using Xu Qingzhu as a threat to get revenge on her.

Moreover, the tone of the last sentence sounded very much like the original owner had done similar things before, so the other party was using the same method to retaliate.

Liang Shi was speechless and silently cursed in her heart: Just how much evil did you fucking do!

Liang Shi blocked her messages and was about to call Liang Xinhe when an unknown number called.

She answered without hesitation: "Hello."

"I'm not well," Zhou Yi'an's teasing voice came through, carrying a sinister undertone. "Watching my darling running around exhausting herself for another woman, how could I be well?"

Liang Shi: "...Did you take Xu Qingzhu away and book tonight's 7588?"

"How could that be?" Zhou Yi'an chuckled lightly. "I'm not interested in your Omega. But darling, you're so useless."

Liang Shi took a deep breath, suppressing the urge to curse: "If you called just to say this, then I'm hanging up."

"Don't hang up yet," Zhou Yi'an clicked her tongue. "My darling is still as impulsive as ever."

Liang Shi: "..."

Who the fuck is your darling?

Getting addicted to disgusting people?

If she didn't think she could get some information from her, Liang Shi would have hung up long ago.

"If you can't provide a solution, don't waste my time," Liang Shi said coldly.

"I can provide one, but what's in it for me?" Zhou Yi'an said with a laugh, like a snake spitting venom in the dark. "If you agree to spend another night with me, then I might consider it."

Liang Shi: "..."

Consider what?

"You sent those text messages, didn't you?" Liang Shi said with certainty. "If this is revenge against me, then come at me directly. What kind of skill is it to hurt innocent people?"

"What text messages?" Zhou Yi'an said. "I don't know what you're talking about."

Liang Shi sneered: "Stop pretending."

She hung up immediately.

Counting on Zhou Yi'an was worse than counting on a stray dog on the street.

Now she could only place all her hopes on the Liang family.

Footnotes:

¹ PTSD: Post-Traumatic Stress Disorder

² National treasures: A euphemistic way to refer to Chinese swear words/profanity

³ Green: In Chinese culture, "wearing a green hat" means being cuckolded, so "green on the head" implies being cheated on

Chapter 23-6

At the same time, she condemned the system in her mind: "Aren't you supposed to be so capable? Now my target could potentially have a PTSD episode and die, and you're just standing by watching? Use your superpowers! Otherwise, if my target dies, what mission am I supposed to complete? Do you just want me to die?"

The system still had that mechanical and eerie voice: "Host, this is something you need to resolve yourself."

Liang Shi: "..."

Yourself?

"She is your target, and during this period, her safety is your responsibility. If something happens, the misfortune value punishment system will discipline you. Don't worry about it."

Liang Shi: "..."

Oh?

Do people nowadays like to add cute particles at the end to show how adorable they are?

Adorable my ass.

This sounded exactly like saying: "I'm going to kill you now, don't be afraid of the pain, just endure it a little."

No different from a psychotic killer.

The system continued: "As entities existing outside the four-dimensional universe, we cannot interfere with three-dimensional space matters."

Liang Shi: "..."

At this moment, Liang Xinhe called her. She hurriedly answered, getting straight to the point: "Second brother, I need a favor."

"What is it?" Liang Xinhe asked.

"Help me open the door to private room 7588," Liang Shi said. "I need to save someone."

"7588?" Liang Xinhe's tone was unfriendly. "You're going to that kind of place again?"

Liang Shi sighed: "It's not me."

This was too complicated to explain.

She simply said: "I'll explain the details to you later. Please help me first—this is a matter of life and death."

Liang Xinhe was silent for a moment on the other end: "I'll try my best, but I can't guarantee success. You know that Huayue International is backed by the Shen family. It's very difficult for ordinary people to establish connections with the Shen family."

"I know. Thank you, second brother. Please hurry," Liang Shi said anxiously.

On the other side, Zhao Xuning held her phone and dialed a long-sealed number.

A long dial tone rang, as if a century had passed.

Zhao Xuning originally thought she wouldn't answer, but unexpectedly, at the last moment, the other party picked up, followed by endless silence.

There were light breathing sounds from the other end of the phone, very slow, as if deliberately softened.

It was still Zhao Xuning who spoke first. She asked in a low voice: "What are you doing?"

A clear, cold voice came through the receiver, carrying a hint of disdain: "Did you call just to ask me this?"

Zhao Xuning pressed her lips together: "No."

Roundabout approaches didn't suit Zhao Xuning.

She let out a light breath and spoke honestly: "I need to open the door to private room 7588 at Huayue International. Can you help?"

The other end laughed: "Long time no see, Miss Zhao is still so..."

She paused, her tone becoming even more indifferent: "Impolite."

"Can you help?" Zhao Xuning became more forceful. "It's urgent."

"Is it your girlfriend trapped inside?" The other party's words carried some probing.

Zhao Xuning's breathing hitched, and she quickly denied: "Just a simple friend."

"Then you like her?" the other party said.

Zhao Xuning was already agitated, and under such continuous questioning, she couldn't help but add some anger to her voice: "Shen Hui, I haven't dated anyone since we broke up."

The person whose name was called paused, but then said mockingly: "What? Do you want me to give Miss Zhao a moral excellence award?"

Zhao Xuning was also tired: "Please help me. Consider it as me owing you."

"You owe me plenty already. What will you use to repay?" Shen Hui's tone was somewhat aggressive.

Zhao Xuning couldn't think of what to say for a moment and only felt weary in her heart.

The phone was suddenly hung up.

Zhao Xuning sighed and asked Liang Shi: "Any progress on your end?"

Liang Shi shook her head: "My second brother went to find someone, but it's probably unlikely."

Zhao Xuning frowned and couldn't help but curse.

"Do you know why Bai Weiwei came here?" Liang Shi asked.

Zhao Xuning shook her head: "Not sure."

She and Bai Weiwei weren't in the kind of relationship where they had to report each other's whereabouts constantly.

On the other side of the city.

An Omega with brown long hair sat up from the bed, got up to get a bottle of red wine from the wine cabinet. The deep red liquid refracted colorful light through the dim yellow lighting in the room, making the room appear empty and lonely.

The latest model phone was quietly placed on the wooden table.

She sat on a high stool, casually pinning up her long hair with a hair clip, with one playful strand still hanging down her chest.

Her white silk pajamas clung smoothly to her body, covering all the alluring scenery.

After drinking a glass of wine, Shen Hui pressed her temples and finally sighed, calling the person in charge of Huayue International.

"Second Miss," the other party's tone was respectful. "How may I help you?"

"Open private room 7588 now," Shen Hui said indifferently.

"Ah, but tonight Miss Cheng is..."

"Don't my words count?" Shen Hui lowered her voice, emanating the aura of someone in power.

"Go open the door to 7588. Don't make me say it a third time."

The other party paused: "Yes, ma'am."

Everyone knew that although Huayue International was nominally under the Cheng family, the real controller was the Shen family.

Without the Shen family, who would think highly of the Cheng family?

To put it bluntly, the Cheng family only had their current status because they had connections with the Shen family.

The person in charge went to handle it efficiently.

Chapter 23-7

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In the hotel corridor, Zhao Xuning and Liang Shi were still searching for people.

Zhao Xuning suddenly stopped and said faintly: "Huayue International is a property under Huaguang Group¹. You should contact Cheng Ran."

Liang Shi was also stunned: "This belongs to Cheng Ran's family?"

Zhao Xuning nodded: "It's registered under her uncle's name, but it's not entirely her family's."

The Cheng family had many branch families and constant internal strife.

So this issue couldn't be explained clearly in a short time.

Zhao Xuning was concise: "Let's call and contact..."

"No need," Liang Shi abruptly interrupted, then sneered. "This whole thing was probably set up by Cheng Ran."

Now everything could be explained.

Why did they know her phone number?

Why was this clearly revenge against her, yet they used Xu Qingzhu as the breakthrough point?

Only Cheng Ran could have done something like this.

She thought that her falling out with Cheng Ran was because of Xu Qingzhu.

"Then what do we do?" Zhao Xuning frowned tightly. "Are we just going to watch them inside..."

She couldn't finish the rest of her words.

Everyone knew that Omega bodies were sensitive.

And Xu Qingzhu also had PTSD.

If an episode occurred without timely rescue, someone could really die.

10:09 PM.

The elevator door opened, and a woman in a white suit appeared at the end of the corridor, walking toward them in eight-centimeter heels.

She walked up to Zhao Xuning and smiled sweetly: "Miss Zhao, long time no see."

Zhao Xuning skipped the pleasantries: "Open the door."

The door's design was very sophisticated. First, it was opened with a hexagonal key, then came facial recognition, and after that, there was another fingerprint scanner.

Three locks in total.

Liang Shi was about to speak to Zhao Xuning when she received a call from Liang Xinhe.

"I asked around," Liang Xinhe said. "Someone has already given word..."

"Mm, someone here is opening it," Liang Shi said.

"Now can you tell me..." Liang Xinhe wanted to inquire, but Liang Shi anxiously interrupted:

"Second brother, I need to go handle this first. I'll explain to you later."

Before hanging up, she politely reminded him: "You should get some rest early."

Liang Xinhe: "...?"

After hanging up, Liang Xinhe stared at the phone, completely puzzled.

He always felt that Liang Shi was acting abnormal.

After the person in charge opened the door, Liang Shi looked at the messy private room and frowned.

Zhao Xuning had the same reaction.

Liang Shi asked: "Where are the people?"

The person in charge smiled: "They've been sent to their rooms."

"Stop talking nonsense and help us find people," Zhao Xuning said. "Bai Weiwei and Xu Qingzhu."

The person in charge paused, their gaze sweeping over their faces, still maintaining a standard smile: "Alright."

Liang Shi felt that everything here was eerily strange.

You'd have to be insane to come up with something so deranged.

After a moment, the wall slowly moved, extending forward to reveal a white corridor.

Both sides were mirrored, making this path seem endless.

"You two can walk to the end of this path to find the people you're looking for." The woman pointed to the left side: "This is Miss Xu's room."

Upon hearing this, Xu Qingya had already run over.

Liang Shi and Zhao Xuning also split up to search for people.

Liang Shi had better stamina than Xu Qingya and ran faster than her.

In just a few seconds, she saw a white door and pushed it open directly.

This room was identical to the photos she had received earlier, but there was only Xu Qingzhu alone on the bed.

A blanket covered her upper body, with only her two long legs exposed.

The bed was all wrinkled.

At this moment, her phone received another text message.

Still from an unknown number.

【I'm letting your Omega go this time.】

【Consider it a freebie. Don't thank me.】

Very infuriating tone.

But Liang Shi had no time to argue with her.

Xu Qingzhu was obviously somewhat unclear mentally. Her two long legs were intertwined, and she was lying on her side with her long hair covering half of her upper body's allure. Her shoulders and arms were exposed outside the blanket. When she heard the door open, she slightly opened her eyes, which showed a faint red.

Her body was burning with unbearable heat, and even her voice was hoarse, yet it still carried her usual tone—clear and cool, but with an upward inflection at the end. When calling someone's name, it carried some suppression, and when it fell on one's ears, it carried a soft, sweet quality. She bit her glistening lower lip and called out hoarsely: "Liang... Shi."

"I'm here." Liang Shi ran over. Looking at Xu Qingzhu like this, she didn't know whether to hold her or not.

But Xu Qingzhu actively reached over, resting her head on Liang Shi's leg.

She was still wearing only a camisole and tight pants, her delicate collarbone exposed and also showing an abnormal flush.

It seemed that person hadn't touched Xu Qingzhu.

Liang Shi felt slightly relieved.

However, anyone could see that Xu Qingzhu was in a very bad state right now.

Her body was soft like a snake, her palms were hot, and she was murmuring something.

Liang Shi bent down to listen.

Xu Qingzhu stretched out her soft arms, actually wrapping them around her neck, and while she was focused, pressed her down onto the bed.

Liang Shi: "...?"

Xu Qingya had just arrived. She covered her eyes and closed the door: "You two continue..."

Liang Shi: "?"

The drug effects hadn't worn off yet on Xu Qingzhu, and her hot hands casually caressed Liang Shi's cheek.

But she still retained a trace of rationality. Those dreamy eyes were misty with moisture, and her hands kept curling up.

Their eyes met.

Xu Qingzhu slowly leaned down, her glistening lips close at hand. She kept breathing in and out, her warm breath hitting Liang Shi's face.

This room was still filled with the scent of strawberry liqueur²—Xu Qingzhu's pheromones were dispersing.

Liang Shi was about to get drunk on this wine-like fragrance.

She thought that no one could resist Xu Qingzhu at this moment.

But just as Xu Qingzhu's lips were about to fall, she turned her face away.

So those glistening lips only barely brushed past her ear, yet it made her entire ear feel as if it were on fire.

Xu Qingzhu's lips missed their target. She buried her head glumly against Liang Shi's neck, her clear, cool voice carrying a slight grievance as she accused: "You're mean."

Liang Shi: "..."

Xu Qingzhu really wasn't clear-headed anymore.

Footnotes:

¹ Huaguang Group: A fictional conglomerate/business group

² Strawberry liqueur: Referring to the scent of Xu Qingzhu's pheromones, which smell like strawberry Baileys cream liqueur